

Roll of the Draw

Game Design Document & Product Requirements

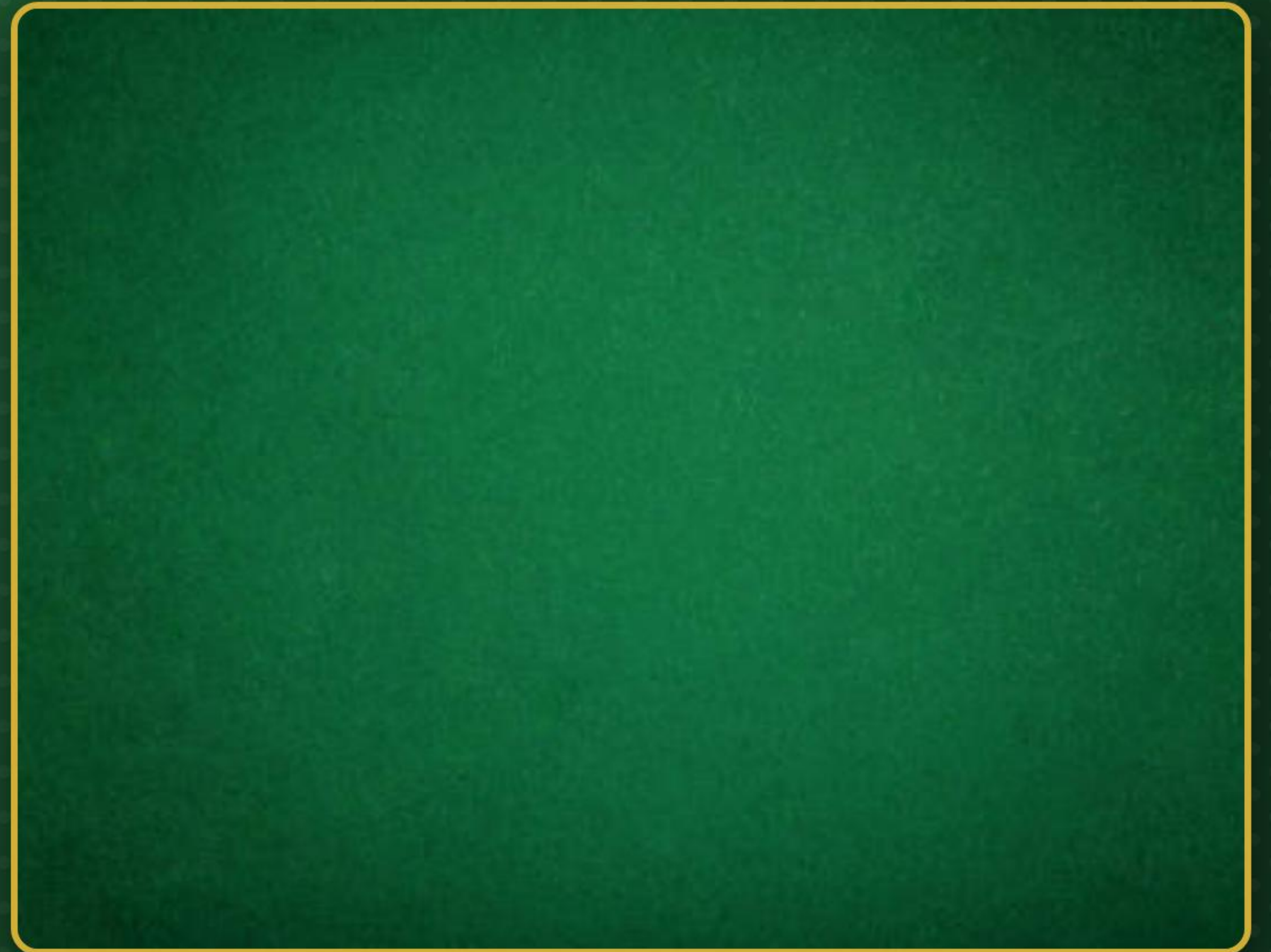
Browser-Based Rogue-lite Deckbuilder

The Vision: High-Stakes Aesthetics

A Tactile Casino Experience

The visual identity revolves around the classic, grounded feel of a high-end casino table. No sci-fi lasers, no neon grids—just pure, textured realism.

- ◆ **The Canvas:** Deep, rich green felt acting as the primary backdrop for the gameplay area.
- ◆ **The Elements:** Heavy ivory dice with indented pips, thick textured card stock, and deep mahogany UI borders.
- ◆ **The Engine:** Players roll 5 dice and use drawn active cards to physically alter the dice faces, creating poker hands.



The Gameplay Loop



1. The Draw

Player draws up to 5 cards per round. Unplayed cards from previous rounds remain in the hand, allowing for strategic hoarding.



2. The Roll & Fix

Player receives a single roll of 5 dice. They spend up to 3 Energy to play active cards, physically manipulating the dice faces.



3. The Score

The locked-in poker hand is calculated, multipliers are applied. Beating the target score awards gold for the shop phase.

Hands & Attempts

5

HANDS PER ROUND

Building the Target Score

The player does not need to beat the target score in a single massive roll. Instead, they are given exactly 5 "Hands" (attempts) to cumulatively reach the Round's target score.

This transforms the game into an efficiency puzzle. Do you blow all your saved cards on Hand 1 for a massive over-score, or distribute your active card usage evenly across all 5 hands to ensure you meet the minimum threshold?

Passive Upgrades: The 5 Jokers



The Engine Builders

While active cards cost energy to manipulate the board, **Jokers** are passive relics that sit at the top of the table on the green felt. They fundamentally alter the math of the scoring engine.

- ◆ **Strict Limit:** Players can only equip a maximum of 5 Jokers at any given time.
- ◆ **Synergy Generation:** Choosing the right combination of 5 Jokers dictates the entire run's strategy (e.g., buffing low pairs vs. chasing straights).
- ◆ **Economy Drive:** Jokers are the most expensive items in the shop, driving the need for interest-bearing gold strategies.

In-Game Economy

Earning Gold

Gold is awarded upon successfully beating a Round.

The base payout is standard, but efficiency is rewarded. Players receive +\$1 for every unspent Energy at the end of the round, plus an Interest bonus (+\$1 for every \$5 held, capped at \$5).

The Shop Phase

Between rounds, players enter the Shop to spend their hoarded gold. The inventory randomly generates 3 Active Cards (to bolster the draw pile) and 2 Jokers (to fill or upgrade the 5 passive slots).

Product Requirements: Tech Stack

Component	Technology Choice	Purpose / Justification
Framework	React + Vite	Fast, component-based SPA architecture suitable for Netlify static hosting.
Styling	Tailwind CSS	Rapid layout building, easily handles responsive CSS grids for 16:9 constraint.
Animations	Framer Motion	Essential for the "juice" — tactile dice tumbling, card drawing, and score counters.
State Manager	Zustand	Lightweight global store for Run State, Wallet, Deck Arrays, and the 5 Joker slots.

The Scoring Algorithm

The core logic is a deterministic reducer function. It takes the array of 5 locked dice, evaluates the poker hand, applies the base value, and multiplies by passive Jokers.

$$\text{Final Score} = \text{Base Hand Chips} + \sum_{i=1}^5 \text{Die Face Value}_i \times \text{Base Hand Mult} + \sum_{j=1}^5 \text{Joker}_j$$

Ready for Vibe Coding?

The mechanics are locked. The logic is discrete.

The aesthetic is defined.



Image Sources



<https://media.istockphoto.com/id/1448470651/photo/green-poker-table.jpg?s=612x612&w=0&k=20&c=Tei4XZXt08ZnbHWeSkHdkk26HQsMQK88HyC7-NcX2Fw=>

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